Me and My Big Fat Mouth (The Bus Story)

By Mike McGee

INTRODUCTION

*Infatuation... we're in love with it! Millions of people live in anxious hope of experiencing **IT** as soon as possible... and over and over again... if necessary. Come to think of it, infatuation has become a popular model for love itself, and at this very moment, infatuation fever is directing the most critical intimate choices of an enormous sub-culture of teens. Infatuation crosses all race, gender, weight ranges, social classes and yes, even cultural cliques . . . there is no rhyme or reason, no rescue from it's clutches . . . . IT can make you do and say things you never thought possible. . . . Trust Me and My Big Fat Mouth by Mike McGee.*

In the summer of 1991
I was 15 years old and 200 pounds
I had spent the weekend in Reno with my
family and we were heading back home
to San Jose on a Greyhound Bus which was, always dull.

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I rested, bored on the harsh cloth and vinyl
seats second to the last in the back of the bus
while listening to Cool Mo D on cheap headphones
and praying for a stranger to consume as
much of my time as possible.

We got to Sacramento and the coolest chick
of all cool chicks got on the bus alone
Her perfume preceded her entrance.
I looked up to see a flash of black.
Black everything.
Pants, boots, makeup, shirt, hair, and book bag.
She was Goth, I guess, but I didn't know what that
meant back then.
But she was.
She was gorgeous.

She was a mystery sitting right behind me
in the last seat on the bus
I stalled and stalled
She was drowning out the world with

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her own headphones—I had to talk to her
So I hopped up and spun around and
kneeled on my seat like those annoying children
resting my chin on the top of the backrest.
She looked up at me.
Reclined and slouched into the book she was reading.
She smirked, like my presence was unusual,
but my spontaneity was somewhat punk rock and
welcome.

I can't remember what exactly started the conversation,
but within fifteen minutes, she had put her
headphones and book away
She told me she only listened to college radio;
now, I had to listen to college radio
She was my age, but she was exotic and cultural
She was dark and lonely and found very little humor in
the world,
but I could make her laugh—Boy, could I make her laugh.

Up until then, humor had always been my wall

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To joke and tease was to defend and protect myself
To deflect any words that could hurt me when I was a
boy
I used my humor to get to them before
they could to me, and I got inside this girl
But the more she opened up, the more I didn't
In an hour we were friends. In another hour
we would be comfortably flirting and joking
around like two people who would eventually
become dorm room lovers.
She thought I was funny.
She thought I was special.
She told me she thought my chubby face was cute
and really wanted to get to know me.
This was the easiest thing I had ever done
We were 15 minutes away from home,
she gave me her address, and in seconds
I realized it would only take me half an hour
and two buses to get from my house to hers.
I promised I would visit her as often as possible.
I even considered transferring to her high school to be

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near her.
She was beautiful.
And I wasn't, and we fit like the last two pieces of
this glorious puzzle completing the most complex
work of abstract art anyone has ever seen.
And we could feel it. There isn't a genius in
the world that could explain to us what was
happening, but we didn't care about details.
We were the world's youngest scientists
committing ourselves to cosmic chemistry on a
Greyhound bus.

I wanted to kiss her so badly and I knew she'd
let me if I could just walk her home.
But I didn't care if I ever got off that bus,
as long as she was
there with me.
We laughed and talked like old friends.
And when we had nothing to say
we just smiled comfortably,
because we both knew the energy between us was magic.

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Nothing could stop us, nothing could hurt us.
She was the first person I was willing to grow up for.
Days could've gone by and we wouldn't have noticed.
We had gone galaxies in a relationship
that still had universes to build on.
She had grown so pleased with my presence
that she had slowly slithered down into her seat,
slouching ever more.
This position of her body forced her to lay on her side.
She looked comfortable but was unaware that
her entire pelvic area was pointed right up at me.
I pretended not to notice, until I joked:

So, do you spread your legs for every guy you meet?

Evil dreads swarmed her face.
At warp speed she ripped her cold book and headphones
out of her bag.
She opened to her dog-eared chapter and
blasted the Smiths into her brain.
I apologized like a cheating husband.

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So close to tears, she wouldn't look at me.

Her guard was down and I attacked.

It only took her 7 seconds to become a stranger all over again.

What was I thinking?

She wasn't ready for that. She didn't deserve that.

We were different. We were gonna get married.

The humor that I had always used to

make friends had backfired for the first time,

but to this day I know I lost more.

I lost the opportunity to walk a cool chick home.

I lost my very first kiss from some awesome

faint black lips.

Faint, because she covered her mouth every

time I made her laugh, wiping away

the gothic façade that first attracted me to her.

It's been so long. I could've fallen in love with her. And

boy, did I.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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